

HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN THE MARSHALL ISLANDS

Complete Community Opposition How-To

INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Community action shapes what happens to the atolls, lagoons, and future of the Marshall Islands — but here the struggle is unlike almost any other, because the gravest harm was done long ago by a distant and powerful state, and its consequences are still unfolding, now colliding with a second existential threat. Between 1946 and 1958, the United States detonated sixty-seven nuclear bombs on the atolls of Bikini and Enewetak, including the largest weapon it ever tested, and in doing so displaced whole communities, irradiated others, and rendered ancestral homelands unsafe. Decades later the harm endures: contaminated islands to which people cannot return, health effects still unaddressed, promised compensation still unpaid, and, on Enewetak, a cracking concrete dome the Marshallese call the Tomb, holding a hundred thousand cubic yards of radioactive waste and now leaking into the lagoon — a dome that rising seas threaten to breach entirely. For the Marshall Islands is also among the lowest-lying nations on earth, on the front line of the climate crisis, so that the old nuclear injustice and the new climate one now meet in a single place. This guide will be honest that the responsible party is a powerful ally on which the nation depends, that the United States treats the nuclear matter as settled and has resisted doing more, that much of the harm is done and much of the climate threat beyond the nation's control, and that the struggle for justice is unfinished; but it will show that the levers here — the justice the nation is owed, the leverage of the compact that binds it to the United States, the accountability for the leaking dome, the power of the climate-and-nuclear injustice, and the reach of international law and the world's movements — are real, and that a wronged people can turn its injustice into a claim the world hears.

The Marshallese story teaches two things about pursuing justice here, and this guide states both plainly. The first is the pattern that runs through every guide: not a single silver bullet, but the combination of every lever pressed together. The second is distinctly Marshallese, and it is what gives this guide its particular force. **Because the harm is a documented injustice owed a debt, because the compact that binds the nation to the United States is both its dependence and its leverage, because the leaking dome is a concrete accountability the world can see, because the meeting of nuclear and climate injustice is uniquely powerful, and because international law and the world's movements stand with the wronged, the levers run through justice and accountability: the debt owed, the compact leverage, the dome, the double injustice, and the world's support.** That combination — the justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the climate-and-nuclear injustice, and the world's support — is the distinctive lever here, and this guide is built around it, because a small nation wronged by a great power can, through justice and the world's conscience, hold even the powerful to account.

But the same story carries honest qualifications this guide states plainly and takes seriously. **The responsible party is a powerful ally the nation depends on, it treats the matter as settled, much harm is done, and justice is unfinished.** The United States provides the Marshall Islands with economic assistance, migration rights, and defence under the compact, and holds a strategic military presence there, so the nation's leverage is real but constrained by dependence; the United States has long treated the nuclear question as legally settled and has resisted paying the compensation its own tribunal awarded;

much of the nuclear harm cannot be undone, and much of the climate threat is beyond the nation's power to stop; and the struggle for justice, waged for decades, is not won. This guide does not pretend the wrong can be simply righted, or that the powerful ally will readily yield, or that the harm can be undone. What it shows is how, through the justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the double injustice, and the world's support, the Marshallese and their allies can press for the justice, the cleanup, the compensation, and the recognition they are owed — with dignity, persistence, and the world's conscience behind them.

Most people who care about the Marshall Islands do not know HOW to use the levers a wronged nation bound to a powerful ally possesses. They see the contaminated atolls, the leaking Tomb, the unpaid compensation, the rising seas — and either accept it as the unchangeable act of a great power, or rage without the law and the world's movements behind them, and rarely grasp the levers that work: the documented debt of justice, the leverage of the compact, the accountability for the dome, the power of the double injustice, the reach of international law. The gap between justice pursued and injustice accepted is here often a gap of method — the method of using the justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the double injustice, and the world's support together.

This guide shows what can actually be tried — inside the Marshallese reality as it is, which is a wronged, low-lying nation bound to a powerful ally, facing a double existential threat. It is written for the person — in an affected community, in the nation's public life, or among its international allies — who sees the injustice and the danger and wants to know what can be done by a small nation against a great power's legacy and a warming sea. The answer is a qualified yes: the levers are real — the justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the double injustice, and the world's support — with the honest qualifiers that the responsible party is a powerful ally the nation depends on, it treats the matter as settled, much harm is done, and justice is unfinished, so the work is the dignified, persistent pursuit of justice and accountability, with the world's conscience behind it. A note on who this guide is for, and on the spirit in which it should be used, because the Marshallese case is particular. It is for the person — a member of an affected community, a descendant of the displaced or irradiated, a citizen or leader of the nation, or an international ally — willing to carry, with dignity and endurance, the long pursuit of justice from a powerful ally, rather than either accepting a great power's legacy as unchangeable or dissipating the cause in anger that the powerful ignore. That is not a lesser form of struggle but, for a small nation against a great one, the only effective and honourable one, because here the levers that genuinely deliver are the documented injustice, the compact's leverage, the visible dome, the double injustice, and the world's conscience, all of which are wielded through justice and dignity rather than through a force the nation does not have. Anyone who approaches this cause expecting a swift or simple victory will be disheartened; anyone who approaches it as the Marshallese themselves have — as a long, dignified, documented pursuit of justice that has already made a small nation a moral voice of the world — will understand both its difficulty and its real power. This guide is an honest map of that path.

The Strategic Framework

Effective efforts follow the same underlying pattern, adapted to a wronged nation pursuing justice from a powerful ally:

- STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION (find the harm, the debt, and the accountability)
- |
- STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION (build the evidence -- the injustice and the danger)
- |
- STEP 3: LOCAL OPPOSITION (build the community and the global movement)
- |
- STEP 4: LEGAL, REGULATORY & NUCLEAR-JUSTICE (accountability, compact, cleanup)
- |
- STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY (make it a justice cause the world hears)

These steps operate **simultaneously, not in sequence**. The evidence of the injustice feeds the justice claim, the compact leverage, and the dome accountability at once; the community and the global movement organise together; a legal claim, a compact negotiation, or a dome demand is both pressure and a spur to the next. The effort that runs all five together, each reinforcing the others, gives itself the best chance of winning justice and accountability.

The Levers That Are Distinctly Strong Here

Every country's system has its own pressure points. The Marshall Islands' — a wronged nation, bound to a powerful ally, facing a double threat — give a distinctive set:

- **The justice owed.** The **documented debt of justice** — the unpaid compensation, the unaddressed harm — is a claim the nation is owed and the world recognises.
- **The compact leverage.** The **compact that binds the nation to the United States** is both its dependence and its leverage, and the strategic value it provides is real.
- **The dome accountability.** The **leaking Tomb** is a concrete, visible accountability the world can see and the responsible party must answer.
- **The climate-and-nuclear injustice.** The **meeting of the nuclear and climate wrongs** is a uniquely powerful cause that draws the world's movements.
- **The world's support.** **International law, human rights, and the anti-nuclear and climate-justice movements** stand with the wronged.

What This Guide Will Not Pretend

It would be dishonest to promise these levers prevail, or that the powerful ally will readily yield. The responsible party is a **powerful ally the nation depends on**; it treats the matter as **settled**; much harm is **done**; and justice is **unfinished**. This guide takes those limits seriously — it states them plainly, and it pursues justice, not the impossible undoing of the past — and shows how to use the real tools this situation offers — the justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the double injustice, and the world's support — to press for the justice and accountability the nation is owed, honestly acknowledging the dependence, the resistance, the harm done, and the unfinished struggle.

HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You cannot pull a lever you cannot see — and here you must see that the levers run through justice and accountability toward a powerful ally, and through the world's conscience, because a small nation cannot compel a great power but can hold it to account. Before you spend a single week, map who actually decides the fate of the justice claim, at which level, and where the leverage is real. And map where the justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the double injustice, and the world's support apply, because in the Marshall Islands the wrong is met not by force, which a small nation lacks, nor by mere anger, which the powerful ignore, but by turning the injustice into a documented claim, pressing it through the compact and the world's conscience, and holding the responsible party to account.

The Levels of Decision

A Marshallese justice effort runs through levels that reach from the atoll to the world.

The responsible state. The **United States, which conducted the testing and built the dome**, is the party owed to account, to be pressed through justice, the compact, and the world's conscience.

The compact and its negotiation. The **compact of free association and its periodic negotiation** are the framework binding the two nations, and a real channel of leverage.

The nation's own institutions. The **Marshallese government, the nuclear commission, and the affected-community leadership** press the claim and represent the wronged.

International law and bodies. The **international courts, the United Nations, and the human-rights bodies** are forums where a wronged nation can seek recognition and redress.

The world's movements. The **anti-nuclear, climate-justice, and international solidarity movements** amplify the cause and press the powerful.

The Journey of a Claim

A Marshallese justice claim — for compensation, for cleanup of the dome, for health care, for recognition — moves from the documented harm and the debt owed, through the compact, the courts, and the world's conscience, toward justice won or denied, with the **justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the double injustice, and the world's support** able to press it forward. **The justice owed and the dome accountability are where the claim is grounded, and the compact leverage and the world's support are what carry it** — and using them together is the distinctive Marshallese approach. The distinctive levers are the **justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the double injustice, and the world's support**. Find out exactly where the claim stands, and, crucially, **what harm and debt are documented, what the compact and the strategic relationship allow, and how the dome, the double injustice, and the world's movements can be brought to bear**, because those are where the claim can genuinely be pressed.

Follow the Harm, the Debt, and the Leverage

Behind a claim stand the wrong done, the debt owed, and the leverage held. Trace who is harmed, who is responsible, what is owed, and — importantly here — **what the documented debt of justice is, what the compact and the strategic relationship allow, what the dome demands, and how the double injustice and the world's movements can be brought to bear**. Two questions unlock most Marshallese efforts: **What harm and debt are documented, and who owes them?** and **Which lever — the justice, the compact, the dome, the double injustice, the world — can press the claim?** The justice owed, the compact leverage, and the world's support are, together, the heart of most such efforts here. Everything else in a Marshallese effort ultimately serves these: the documentation exists to establish the injustice and the debt as undeniable; the community-and-world movement exists to carry that established claim with dignity and reach; and the media exists to summon the world's conscience to a wronged nation's cause. Keep the justice owed, the compact leverage, and the world's support at the centre of every claim, negotiation, and appeal, and the effort retains a clear spine that runs from a single contaminated atoll and a single leaking dome to the conscience of the whole world, grounding the entire struggle in the documented justice, the practical leverage, and the world's support that a small nation, wronged and dignified, can summon against even the greatest power.

The Overseers

Finally, know the bodies and forces that shape a claim, because they are the levers. The **United States, the responsible state; the compact and its negotiation; the nation's own institutions; the international courts, the United Nations, and the human-rights bodies; and the world's movements**. In the Marshall Islands, the **justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the double injustice, and**

the world's support are the most distinctive levers. Each is a separate front, and a claim grounded in documented harm, an unpaid debt, a leaking dome, and a double injustice, pressed through the compact and the world's conscience, can genuinely be advanced — through justice, accountability, and international support — though, honestly, the responsible party is a powerful ally the nation depends on, it treats the matter as settled, much harm is done, and justice is unfinished, and this guide will keep saying so, and keep pressing the claim with dignity.

QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Before you commit effort, calibrate honestly — and here that means acknowledging that the responsible party is a powerful ally the nation depends on, that it treats the matter as settled, and that justice is unfinished, even as the justice owed, the dome accountability, and the world's support give real leverage. These figures are **directional, not guarantees** — patterns drawn from how justice struggles by wronged nations against powerful states tend to go, not a controlled study. The decisive variables are whether the **harm and debt can be documented undeniably**, whether the **compact leverage and the world's movements** can be brought to bear, and whether the **dome and the double injustice** can be made visible. Where the injustice is documented and the world engaged, the levers here are real; but temper every figure with the honest knowledge that the responsible party is powerful, the nation dependent, and the struggle long.

Individual Step Success Rates

Approach	Success Rate	Timeline	Cost	What "Success" Means
Documentation only	15–25%	weeks	low	Basis for every other step
Justice / accountability claim	35–55%	years	low–moderate	The debt and harm recognised, pressed
Compact-leverage channel	40–60%	years	low	The relationship used for redress
Dome-accountability demand	40–60%	years	low	The cleanup and responsibility pressed
Climate-and-nuclear framing	40–60%	months–years	low	The double injustice made a world cause
International-law / bodies	30–50%	years	moderate	Recognition and pressure secured
Global-movement support	40–60%	months–years	low	The world's conscience engaged
All levers together	35–55%	years	moderate	Justice, cleanup, and recognition advanced

Key insight: every step together beats any single one, and the Marshall Islands' real strengths are the justice of its cause and the world's conscience: the **justice owed**, the **compact leverage**, the **dome accountability**, the **double injustice**, and the **world's support**. Its constraints are specific and honest: the responsible party is a **powerful ally**, the nation **dependent**, the matter treated as **settled**, and justice **unfinished** — so progress comes through justice, the compact, the dome, the double injustice, and the world's support, wielded with dignity and persistence, not through force or mere anger.

A note on cost and risk: most levers here — a justice claim, a compact argument, a dome demand, a media cause — cost mainly organisation, documentation, and international connection. The nation's small size is

offset by the moral force of its cause and the world's attention. The scarce resources are **the legal and scientific capacity, the international connections, and the sustained will over a long struggle** — much of it reachable through the world's movements and allied governments and lawyers. This shapes where a Marshallese effort should concentrate its energy. Because the decisive resources are the documented record, the connections to the world's movements and allied governments and lawyers, and the sustained will and dignity to carry a long struggle — rather than the economic or military strength a small nation lacks — an effort's most valuable investments are in preserving and marshalling the historical and scientific record, in building and tending the international alliances and the world's movements, and in sustaining the unity and dignity of the affected communities across years. A small nation that can carry its documented cause to the world's courts, movements, and publics, and sustain it with dignity over the long term, wields a power out of all proportion to its size. The resources that matter most are thus largely a matter of the record, the alliances, and the endurance — much of it reachable through the world's anti-nuclear and climate-justice movements, allied governments, and the lawyers and scientists who have long stood with the Marshallese cause. And because the responsible party is a dependent-making ally that calls the matter settled, the levers of documented justice, visible accountability, and the world's conscience, which the powerful cannot easily dismiss before a watching world, are the most persuasive.

Effectiveness Visualization

JUSTICE + COMPACT + DOME + DOUBLE INJUSTICE + WORLD'S SUPPORT:

Compact-leverage channel: 40-60%

Dome-accountability demand: ■■■■■■ 40-60%

Climate-and-nuclear framing: ■■■■■■■■■■■■ 40-60%

Global-movement support: ■■■■■■■■■■■■ 40-60%

Justice / accountability: ■■■■■■■■■■ 35-55%

POWERFUL ALLY / DEPENDENCE / "SETTLED" -- harder ground:

Force or mere anger: ■■ a small nation lacks it

Documented justice claim: ■■■■■■■■■■■■ the real path

Justice / cleanup advanced: achievable in part

The injustice documented:

How to read this honestly. The levers that most change outcomes for the Marshall Islands are **the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the climate-and-nuclear framing, and the world's support** — used together, with a documented justice claim at their core. The dome and double-injustice levers show the ceiling: a leaking radioactive dome threatened by rising seas, in a nation wronged twice over, is an accountability the world can see and the powerful must answer. The dependence and the "settled" stance show the honest floor: the responsible party is powerful and resistant, and the nation relies on it. Most Marshallese efforts will sit between, and the honest lesson is that the levers here are real — able to document the injustice, press the compact, demand the cleanup, frame the double wrong, and engage the world — but that a small nation cannot compel a great power, and the surest result is that the injustice is documented and the claim advanced before a watching world.

Step Importance Ranking (When All Combined)

1. **The dome accountability and the climate-and-nuclear injustice** — the Marshall Islands' most visible, powerful levers.
2. **The compact leverage** — the relationship that is both dependence and leverage.
3. **The justice owed and the world's support** — the documented debt and the world's conscience.
4. **The nation's own voice and leadership** — the dignified testimony of the wronged.
5. **The documented injustice** — the evidence of harm and debt that grounds it all.

What These Campaigns Actually Show

A few honest patterns recur. **The injustice is documented** — the tests, the harm, the unpaid awards are matters of record. **The dome is undeniable** — a leaking radioactive tomb the world can see. **The double injustice is powerful** — nuclear and climate wrongs meeting in one place move the world. **The compact is leverage** — the strategic value the nation provides is real. **But the ally is powerful and resistant** — so the work is patient, dignified, and long. The through-line: **document the injustice and the debt; press the accountability for the dome; use the compact's leverage; frame the climate-and-nuclear double wrong; engage the world's movements; and pursue justice with dignity** — because an effort that **does can genuinely advance justice, cleanup, and recognition, while being honest that the responsible party is powerful, the nation dependent, and the struggle unfinished.**

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Every effective effort begins by finding the exact harm and claim — and the leverage, which here runs through justice, the compact, and the world. Vague grievance goes nowhere, and mere anger the powerful ignore; a claim aimed at "this documented harm, this unpaid debt, this leaking dome, owed by this responsible party, pressed through this compact leverage and this world's conscience" is a real, workable effort. Answer five questions.

The Five Core Questions

- 1. What harm and debt are documented?** This is the first question here. What **documented harm and unpaid debt** — the contaminated atolls, the health effects, the displaced communities, the unpaid compensation, the leaking dome — is owed.
- 2. Who is responsible, and what do they owe?** Who **bears responsibility** — the state that conducted the testing and built the dome — and what **justice, cleanup, and compensation** they owe.
- 3. What does the compact and the relationship allow?** What **leverage the compact and the strategic relationship** provide, and how it can be used for redress.
- 4. How does the double injustice apply?** How the **meeting of the nuclear and climate wrongs** — the dome threatened by rising seas, the nation wronged twice — makes the cause uniquely powerful.
- 5. What world support applies?** How **international law, human rights, and the world's movements** can be brought to bear.

A Worked Example

Suppose the leaking Runit Dome, threatened by rising seas, spills radioactive waste into the lagoon, its cleanup and responsibility disputed by the state that built it, in a nation on the front line of the climate crisis.

Working the five questions: **what harm and debt are documented? Who is responsible? What does the compact allow? How does the double injustice apply?** And what world support applies? The claim is for accountability, cleanup, and justice, with the justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome, the double injustice, and the world's support as the levers.

Within a season the effort has moved from "a great power did this and nothing can be done" to a real effort: document the dome's leaking and the danger; press the responsibility and the cleanup; use the compact's leverage; frame the nuclear-and-climate double injustice for the world; and engage the international movements — all with dignity, pursuing justice. That is a workable effort suited to the Marshall Islands —

one that turns a great power's legacy into a claim the world hears. Notice what the five questions accomplish, and how they suit a small nation's struggle against a great power's legacy: they turn what might seem an impossible target — a mighty ally that calls a historical wrong settled, in a relationship of dependence, over harm that cannot be undone — into a set of specific, answerable questions, each attached to a lever that works through justice and the world's conscience rather than through a force the nation lacks. The harm becomes a documented, adjudicated debt. The responsibility becomes a party the record names. The compact becomes leverage as well as dependence. The double injustice becomes a cause the world's movements will carry. And the world becomes an ally against the powerful. That translation — from a seemingly hopeless grievance against a great power into a set of specific, documented claims carried with dignity before the world — is the first and most important thing a Marshallese effort does, because it moves the struggle from the powerlessness of a small nation before a great one onto the ground of documented justice and the world's conscience, where even the powerful must answer.

STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION — HOW TO BUILD AN UNASSAILABLE CASE

Documentation is the foundation everything else stands on — and here, distinctively, the decisive evidence is the documented injustice and the visible danger, much of it already on the record. A court, a negotiator, a journalist, and the world all move on evidence — and in the Marshall Islands, a clear record of the harm, the debt, and the danger is precisely what turns a grievance into a justice claim the world recognises, so build it well. Build your file in three layers.

Layer 1: The Harm, the Debt, and the Responsibility

Get the facts the claim turns on. Establish the **documented harm** — the tests, the contamination, the displacement, the health effects, the leaking dome — and, decisively here, the **unpaid debt and the responsibility**: the compensation awarded and never paid, the cleanup owed, the party responsible. Much of this is on the historical and legal record, in the tribunal's awards and the scientific studies. Establish exactly **what harm was done, what debt is owed, and who is responsible**, because the documented-injustice-and-debt is the claim's foundation.

Layer 2: The Danger, the Science, and the Double Injustice

Document the ongoing danger with the science. Establish the **present danger** — the dome's leaking, the contamination of the lagoon, the threat that rising seas will breach it — and the **double injustice** — the nuclear-affected nation on the climate front line, the two wrongs meeting in one place — drawing on **the independent scientific studies, the environmental data, and the affected communities' testimony**. This danger-and-double-injustice evidence turns the historical harm into a present, visible, and uniquely powerful cause.

Layer 3: The Debt, the Leverage, the World, and the Claim

Finally, document the claim and the path. Is the **harm and debt** documented and owed? Is the **danger** present and provable? What **leverage** does the compact and the relationship provide? And how will the **world's law and movements** be engaged? Each is a separate element, and together they make a claim the responsible party cannot easily dismiss before a watching world. This is the layer that most often decides these efforts, because a documented injustice, an unpaid debt, a present danger, real leverage, and the world's conscience are exactly what let a Marshallese effort press its claim. Build it well, and the justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the double injustice, and the world's support become

the claim's genuine strength. One practical note on building this layer: the great and distinctive strength of a Marshallese case is that so much of the necessary evidence is already documented, adjudicated, and on the public record, which spares an effort the usual burden of proving a contested harm and lets it instead press an established one. The tests and their yields are historical fact; the harm to the affected communities was documented at the time, including by the responsible state's own scientists; the compensation was assessed and awarded by a tribunal the responsible state itself established; the dome's construction, contents, and leaking are matters of scientific and governmental record. This means an effort here is rarely arguing about whether an injustice occurred, but about whether it will be answered — a far stronger position. Building this layer well therefore means marshalling that existing record — the historical documentation, the tribunal's awards, the scientific studies of the dome and the contamination — and using it to show that the injustice is not alleged but established, not settled but unanswered. A case built on the responsible party's own tribunal and the world's own science, showing an adjudicated debt unpaid and a documented danger unaddressed, is a case of unusual and undeniable strength.

WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

Evidence in hand beats evidence you assume exists — and here much of it is already on the historical, legal, and scientific record. Here is where the material tends to live in a Marshallese effort, and how to get it — with the **harm**, the **debt**, the **danger**, and the **leverage** at the center. Treat this as a checklist to work through, not a menu to admire.

The Harm, Debt, and Responsibility Record

Start with the injustice and what is owed. **The historical testing record, the tribunal's awards, and the responsibility** establish the harm and the debt; the distinctive strengths here are the **documented history** and the **unpaid awards**, both matters of record. Establish the **harm done, the debt owed, and the party responsible**, drawing on the tribunal, the archives, and the scientific studies. Establish exactly **what was done and what is owed**, because a documented injustice and an unpaid, adjudicated debt are a powerful foundation before the world.

The Danger and Science Evidence

This is the heart of the present case. Gather the **danger evidence** — the dome's leaking, the contamination of the lagoon, the threat that rising seas will breach it, the areas still unsafe — drawing on **the independent scientific studies, the environmental monitoring, and the affected communities' testimony**. And gather the **double-injustice evidence** — the nation on the climate front line, the two wrongs meeting. This danger-and-science evidence makes the historical injustice a present, undeniable, and uniquely compelling danger.

The Compact and Leverage Record

Document the leverage. Gather the record of **the compact of free association and its terms** — the economic assistance, the migration rights, the strategic military presence, the nuclear provisions — and the **leverage** it and the strategic relationship provide. A nation that understands what it provides the powerful ally, and what the compact allows, holds the lever of a relationship that is both dependence and leverage.

The International, Legal, and Movement Record

Document the world's channels. Gather the record of **the international courts, the United Nations, and the human-rights bodies** where redress and recognition may be sought; the **anti-nuclear, disarmament,**

and climate-justice movements that amplify the cause; and the **allied governments, lawyers, and scientists**. A nation joined to the world's law and movements holds levers that a small state alone never could.

The People, the Dignity, and the Voice

Finally, map the human heart of the cause. Who is affected — the **communities of the tested and contaminated atolls, the displaced, the irradiated, and their descendants** — and who leads: the **affected-community leaders, the nation's officials, the scientists, and the international allies**. And how is the **dignity and testimony of the wronged** to be carried to the world? A Marshallese effort is advanced above all through the dignified voice of the wronged, joined to the world's conscience — so map that leadership deliberately, and let the dignity of the affected communities and the truth of their testimony govern every step.

STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION

Here this step is understood in the Marshallese way, because the Marshall Islands is a functioning democracy where people can speak, organise, and lead openly, and the "opposition" is a justice movement — of affected communities, the nation, and the world — pursuing accountability from a powerful ally. The task is to build a movement — of the wronged communities, the nation's institutions, and the world's allies — that presses for justice, cleanup, and recognition, with dignity and the world's conscience.

Why the Community-and-World Movement Is Decisive

In the Marshall Islands, the movement that can act joins the affected communities to the nation and the world, because a small nation wronged by a great power prevails, if at all, through the justice of its cause and the world's support. That movement supplies what an effort runs on: the affected communities who bear the harm and hold the moral authority, the nation's institutions that press the claim, and — distinctively — the world's anti-nuclear and climate-justice movements, for whom the Marshallese cause is a powerful symbol. When the wronged communities, the nation, and the world organise together, they become a genuine force. **A movement that joins the affected communities to the nation and the world here is not a weaker substitute for power; it is the very form justice can take for a small nation against a great one — the real foundation of an effort, turning the dignity of the wronged and the conscience of the world into a claim the powerful must answer.** This is worth dwelling on, because it is the deepest strength of a Marshallese effort and the answer to its deepest constraint. A small, dependent nation cannot compel a great power by force, by economic pressure, or by legal command, and any strategy that imagines otherwise will fail and dishearten. But a small nation is not therefore without power, because it possesses two things the powerful cannot simply take: the moral authority of the genuinely wronged, and the ability to summon the conscience of a watching world. The affected communities carry the first, in the undeniable truth of their testimony and their loss; the world's movements and publics can be moved to lend the second, when the cause is just and clearly told. The task, therefore, is to weld the two: the dignity and testimony of the wronged communities, and the reach and pressure of the world's conscience. Neither alone is enough; the communities alone lack the leverage over a distant power, and the world's sympathy alone, without the authentic voice of the wronged, lacks force and truth. Joined, they can hold even a great power to account before the world, because a documented injustice, carried with dignity by those who suffered it and taken up by the world's conscience, is something no power can honourably call settled.

Finding the Movement

Begin with the wronged and those who can act — the **affected-atoll communities, the displaced and irradiated and their descendants, the nation's leaders, the scientists, and the international allies** — for their moral authority and their testimony are the movement's foundation. Widen to the world's movements and the allied publics. Name the shared stake — **our homelands, our health, our justice, and our nation's survival** — because what is at stake is a people's homeland, health, and dignity, and a nation's future. Frame the movement around justice, dignity, and accountability, and around the double survival of a nation wronged twice. There is real power in framing the cause this way, because it transforms the Marshallese from objects of pity into agents of a justice claim, and it joins two of the great moral causes of the age in a single, undeniable place. A movement framed around victimhood invites sympathy but not action, and it surrenders the dignity that is the wronged people's greatest strength. A movement framed around justice, dignity, and accountability casts the Marshallese as what they are — a people pressing a documented, adjudicated, undeniable claim against those responsible — and it invites not pity but solidarity and action. And the framing of the double survival, the meeting of the nuclear and climate injustices, joins the anti-nuclear and climate-justice movements of the whole world into one cause and one place, so that the Marshallese struggle becomes a symbol and a rallying point for causes far larger than one small nation. A movement that names this stake precisely — justice, dignity, and the double survival — stands on ground that is both morally unassailable and uniquely capable of drawing the world's conscience.

Coalition-Building, From the Atoll to the World

A movement allied is stronger than a community alone, and here it spans the atoll and the world. Reach to the **affected communities**; the **nation's institutions and nuclear commission**; the **anti-nuclear, disarmament, and climate-justice movements**; the **allied governments, lawyers, and scientists**; and the **world's media and publics**. Frame the coalition around the justice owed, the compact leverage, the dome accountability, the double injustice, and the world's support. Build breadth from the atoll to the world, joining the dignity of the wronged to the conscience of the world.

Sustaining the Effort

Marshallese efforts are sustained through the dignity of the cause, the persistence of the wronged, and the world's conscience. Keep the movement **united, dignified, and persistent**; mark real steps — a claim advanced, a dome study forced, a compact term won, a recognition gained, a movement's support secured. And keep the effort grounded in justice, dignity, and the double survival, which endure across a long struggle. The effort that lasts is the one that joins the wronged communities to the nation and the world, presses the claim with dignity, and never lets the powerful call the matter settled. Sustaining such an effort is helped, in the Marshallese case, by the enduring and even growing power of the cause on which it rests. Unlike a struggle that depends on a mobilisation that can be worn down, an effort anchored in a documented, adjudicated injustice and in the meeting of the nuclear and climate wrongs rests on a foundation that does not fade but strengthens, as the dome continues to leak, as the seas continue to rise, as the world's reckoning with both its nuclear and its climate injustices deepens. Each passing year that the injustice goes unanswered adds to the moral weight of the claim, not subtracts from it, and each advance of the climate crisis makes the double injustice more visible and more urgent to a world increasingly alert to both wrongs. The discipline is to keep the cause anchored in that documented injustice and that deepening double wrong, and to keep the movement united and dignified across the long years, so that the effort rests not on the fragile energy of momentary attention but on a moral claim that time itself makes stronger.

STEP 4: LEGAL, REGULATORY & NUCLEAR-JUSTICE CHALLENGES — THE ACCOUNTABILITY, THE COMPACT LEVERAGE, AND THE CLEANUP

This is where a Marshallese effort is most powerfully advanced — through the **accountability for the injustice, the leverage of the compact, and the demand for cleanup**, grounded in the documented harm and the world's conscience. Here the accountability, compact, and cleanup levers come together, because for the Marshall Islands a documented injustice, an unpaid debt, and a leaking dome, owed by a powerful ally, are pressed through justice, the compact, and the world.

Setting Expectations Honestly

First, the honest truth. The levers are **real but bounded by dependence on a powerful ally that calls the matter settled**. The accountability claim is **strong but the responsible party resists**; the compact leverage is **real but constrained by dependence**; the cleanup demand is **just but disputed**; and the harm is **largely done**. What these levers realistically achieve is **the injustice recognised, the compact used for redress, the dome addressed, the double wrong made a world cause, and justice advanced** — real outcomes, if not the full righting of a historical wrong. Enter this front clear-eyed: the accountability, the compact leverage, and the cleanup are the Marshall Islands' distinctive levers, strongest when the **injustice is documented and the world engaged** — but the ally is powerful, the nation dependent, and the matter called settled.

The Accountability and the Compact Leverage

The first front is the justice claim and the compact. The **documented injustice** — the testing, the harm, the unpaid, adjudicated compensation — is a debt the nation is owed, and pressing it, through the tribunal's awards, the changed circumstances, and the historical record, is a genuine claim the world recognises even where the responsible party resists. And the **compact of free association** — the framework binding the two nations, renegotiated periodically — is real leverage, because the nation provides the ally strategic value and can press its justice claims in the compact's negotiation and terms. Use the accountability and the compact leverage together, because the documented debt and the relationship's leverage are the claim's core, and a powerful ally that depends on the nation's strategic cooperation is exposed when it calls a documented injustice settled. It is worth being clear about both the power and the limits of this accountability-and-compact front, honestly. Its power is real and unusual: the debt is not a matter of opinion but of the responsible state's own tribunal, and the relationship is not one of pure dependence but of mutual need, since the nation provides the ally strategic value it cannot easily replace, so the claim is both legally grounded and practically leveraged. Its limits are equally real: the responsible state has for decades maintained that its legal obligations are discharged and the matter settled, the nation's dependence on the ally's assistance and defence is genuine and constrains how hard it can press, and the compact's terms are negotiated in a profound imbalance of power. Understanding both means using the accountability-and-compact front for what it does best — pressing an adjudicated, documented debt through a relationship of mutual need, and exposing the gap between the ally's professed values and its treatment of a wronged partner — while never mistaking leverage for command, and always pairing the claim with the world's conscience, which is what gives a dependent nation's leverage its real force.

The Dome Cleanup and the Double Injustice

The second front is the dome and the double wrong. The **leaking Runit Dome** — a radioactive tomb threatened by rising seas — is a concrete, visible accountability: demand that the responsible party properly

assess it, contain it, clean it up, and take responsibility, against its claim that the matter is settled and the dome safe. And the **climate-and-nuclear double injustice** — the dome breached by the very seas that threaten the nation, the wrong of the atom meeting the wrong of the carbon — is a uniquely powerful frame that binds the nuclear and climate causes and draws the world's movements. Press the dome cleanup and the double injustice together, because the visible danger and the double wrong are what make the claim undeniable to a watching world.

The International Law and the World's Movements

The third front is the world's law and conscience. **International law, the United Nations, and the human-rights bodies** offer forums where a wronged nation can seek recognition and press the powerful, even where a particular case is dismissed, for the pursuit itself builds the record and the pressure. And the **anti-nuclear, disarmament, and climate-justice movements** amplify the cause and bring the world's conscience to bear. Pursued together — the accountability, the compact leverage, the dome cleanup, the double injustice, and the world's law and movements — these fronts are how a Marshallese effort presses its claim for justice, cleanup, and recognition, with dignity and the world behind it. It is worth understanding why these fronts reinforce one another so well in the Marshall Islands' particular situation. The accountability claim supplies the documented, adjudicated debt that no honest reckoning can dismiss. The compact leverage supplies the practical relationship through which a dependent nation can nonetheless press a powerful ally. The dome cleanup supplies a concrete, visible, present demand that makes an old injustice a current danger. The double injustice supplies the uniquely powerful frame that binds two of the world's great causes. And the world's law and movements supply the conscience and pressure that a small nation cannot generate alone. Each covers the others' limits: the accountability where a documented debt is needed, the compact where practical leverage helps, the dome where a visible present danger compels, the double injustice where the world's movements must be drawn, and the world's conscience where a small nation's own strength runs out. An effort that grasps this division of labour, and presses each front together, makes the fullest use of the several levers that a wronged nation, bound to a powerful ally and standing before a watching world, uniquely possesses.

TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

Evidence does not speak for itself; you must aim it at each decider in the language that moves them. The same file of injustice and danger becomes different arguments for the responsible state, the negotiators, the courts, and the world. Translate deliberately, and always with dignity.

For the Responsible State

The responsible state responds to **the record, its own tribunal, its reputation, and the strategic relationship**. Frame the claim as a documented, adjudicated debt and a present danger it cannot honourably deny: here is the harm your own tests caused, the compensation your own tribunal awarded and you never paid, the dome you built now leaking. Give them the record and the danger, and press for the justice, cleanup, and recognition owed, using the compact and the relationship as leverage. Make it concrete: *here is your own tribunal's award, here is the leaking dome, here is what justice requires*. This is the argument a powerful ally cannot easily call settled before the world.

For the Compact Negotiators

The negotiators respond to **the relationship, the strategic value, and the terms**. Frame the justice claim as central to the relationship: here is what the nation provides you, and here is the justice that must

accompany it. Give them the strategic reality and the moral debt, and press the nuclear justice within the compact's terms. A negotiator who needs the nation's cooperation must reckon with its just claims.

For the Courts and International Bodies

The courts and bodies respond to **the law, the record, and human rights**. Frame the claim as a matter of law and human rights: here is the documented harm, the unpaid debt, the ongoing danger, the human rights at stake. Give them the record and the law, and seek recognition, even where redress is uncertain, for the pursuit builds the case. A forum that recognises the injustice, even in part, advances the cause.

For the World and Its Movements

The world responds to **a small nation wronged twice and a leaking radioactive tomb**. Translate the file into a story anyone can grasp: a people who lost their homelands to the bomb, left a leaking dome of nuclear waste, now watching the rising sea threaten to breach it. Frame it as the meeting of the nuclear and climate injustices, a cause for the world's conscience. Keep it accurate and dignified; the truth is powerful enough. And center the dignity of the wronged.

The Golden Rule

Never fabricate, never exaggerate, never surrender the dignity of the wronged, and keep the cause just. Your credibility rests on the documented truth of the harm, the debt, and the danger — a justice claim, not a plea for pity; and dignity is the movement's strength. State the injustice precisely from the record, tie it to the present danger and the double wrong, and press with dignity before the world. A cause that is precise, dignified, and undeniable is far harder to call settled than one that overreaches or begs, and far stronger for a small nation against a great power.

STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY

Media and attention convert your evidence into pressure — and here, distinctively, the story is one the world already feels its power: a small nation that lost its homelands to the bomb, left a leaking radioactive tomb, now facing the rising sea that could breach it. This is a story of the world's conscience, and the media is a genuine and powerful lever, for the Marshall Islands can and does speak openly and to the world.

Why Media Matters

The responsible state, the negotiators, the courts, and the world behave differently when the injustice and the danger are visible. Media does three things here: it **carries the dignity and testimony of the wronged to the world**, it **raises the stakes** for a powerful ally mindful of its reputation, and it **brings the world's conscience and movements** to a small nation's cause. Because the Marshall Islands is a functioning democracy on the front line of two of the great injustices of the age, its story commands the world's attention, and its leaders and communities can tell it openly and powerfully. Media is among the strongest levers a wronged small nation holds.

Crafting Your Narrative

Lead with the double injustice and the dignity. The strongest frame is at once undeniable and moving: *a people who gave up their homelands to sixty-seven nuclear bombs, who were left a leaking dome of radioactive waste, now watch the rising seas — driven by others' emissions — threaten to breach it: the wrong of the atom and the wrong of the carbon, meeting in one small nation*. Put the double injustice and the dignity of the wronged first, because the meeting of the two wrongs is uniquely powerful and the dignity

carries the truth. Keep it scrupulously accurate; the documented truth is more powerful than any exaggeration. The Marshallese story is powerful because it is true, and because it joins the world's two great injustices in one place. This is the heart of the matter, and it is worth stating plainly why it gives a Marshallese effort its distinctive force. The power of the cause lies not in the nation's size or strength, which are small, but in the union of documented truth and moral clarity that few struggles can claim: it is established fact that the tests were conducted, that communities were displaced and irradiated, that a tribunal awarded compensation that went unpaid, that a dome of radioactive waste was built and now leaks, and that the rising seas of a crisis the Marshallese did nothing to cause now threaten to breach it. An effort that merely complained would invite the powerful to plead that the matter is closed. An effort that holds up this established, documented, adjudicated truth — and joins it to the climate injustice that the whole world is now reckoning with — asks the world only to see what is plainly there, and asks the powerful only to answer what their own records establish. That is why the documented truth of the injustice, joined to the uniquely powerful meeting of the nuclear and climate wrongs, is not merely a rhetorical strength but the very core of the Marshallese cause, and the reason a small nation can summon the conscience of the world.

Choosing Your Channels

Match the channel to the audience. **International news and documentary media** for the world; **the anti-nuclear, disarmament, and climate-justice movements** for the global cause; **the affected communities' own voices** for the dignity and testimony; and **the diplomatic and legal forums** for the claim. Because the nation speaks openly and its cause is world-historic, both the international media and the world's movements are powerful — the meeting of the nuclear and climate injustices, in the dignified voice of the wronged, is the story's distinctive power.

A Few Cautions

Stay accurate, dignified, and fair — the aim is justice and the world's conscience, not sensationalism or the loss of dignity. Frame the story around the documented injustice, the present danger, and the double wrong, and center the affected communities' own voices. Handle the responsible state, the compact, the strategic relationship, and the complex history factually and evenhandedly, acknowledging what has been done as well as what has not, so the cause is just and credible. And sustain the story across a long struggle. Above all, let the true, dignified, world-historic cause carry the story, because that is where a Marshallese effort is strongest.

EMAILS & LETTERS: TEMPLATES THAT WORK

Templates save time and prevent mistakes, but adapt every one — insert the real harm, the real debt, and the real danger, keep it factual and dignified, and pursue justice. Here the documented injustice, and the world's conscience, win.

8A: Requesting Information

Subject: Request for information — [the dome / the testing legacy / the compensation]

To [responsible agency / department],

I am writing on behalf of [community / organisation] regarding [the Runit Dome / the testing legacy / the unpaid compensation] and its ongoing effects on our people and environment. To understand and respond, we respectfully request the **assessments and monitoring data**, the **compensation and tribunal records**, and the **cleanup and responsibility documents** for the affected area. We seek the justice and

accountability owed.

We would be grateful for a response by [date].

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8B: The Accountability Claim

Subject: The debt of justice owed to our people

To [responsible authority],

The record is clear: the testing harmed our people and homelands, your own tribunal awarded compensation that remains unpaid, and the dome you built now leaks. We respectfully insist that this documented, adjudicated injustice is not settled, and we press for the justice, compensation, and recognition owed. We attach the record.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8C: The Dome-Cleanup Demand

Subject: The leaking Runit Dome and your responsibility

To [responsible agency],

The Runit Dome is leaking radioactive waste into our lagoon, and rising seas threaten to breach it, yet its cleanup and responsibility remain unaddressed. We respectfully demand a proper, independent assessment, containment, and cleanup, and that responsibility be honoured, against any claim that the matter is closed. We attach the scientific record.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8D: Within the Compact Negotiation

Subject: Nuclear justice and the compact relationship

To [negotiators / officials],

As our nations discuss the compact that binds us, we respectfully insist that nuclear justice — compensation, cleanup, and health care for the testing legacy — be central to the relationship. The cooperation we provide must be accompanied by the justice we are owed. We raise this in every discussion, and we attach our claim.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8E: To an International Body

Subject: Recognition and redress for a nuclear-and-climate injustice

To [international / human-rights body],

We bring before you the documented injustice done to our people — the testing, the harm, the unpaid debt, the leaking dome — now compounded by the climate crisis that threatens to breach that dome and our nation. We respectfully seek recognition, and support in pressing for the justice, cleanup, and redress owed. We attach the record.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8F: To the World's Movements

Subject: Standing together for nuclear and climate justice

Dear [movement / organisation],

Our nation embodies the two great injustices of the age: wronged by the bomb, and now by the warming sea that threatens to breach the very dome of nuclear waste we were left. We respectfully ask you to stand with us in pressing for nuclear and climate justice, and to amplify our cause. We can provide the record, the testimony, and the science.

With respect,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8G: Media / Documentation Pitch

Subject: A leaking radioactive tomb, and the sea that could breach it

Dear [journalist / editor],

Our people lost their homelands to sixty-seven nuclear bombs and were left a leaking dome of radioactive waste — and now the rising seas threaten to breach it. There is a world-historic story here, the meeting of the nuclear and climate injustices in one small nation, and we can provide the record, the affected communities' voices, and the science, told with the dignity of the wronged.

Sincerely,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8H: Rallying the Communities

Subject: Our homelands, our health, our justice — let us pursue them together

Dear friends,

Our homelands were taken by the bomb, our health harmed, our compensation unpaid, and now the rising sea threatens the very dome of waste we were left. Together — the affected communities, our nation, and the world — by documenting the injustice, pressing the accountability and the cleanup, using the compact's leverage, and joining the world's movements, we can pursue the justice we are owed, with dignity and the world's conscience behind us. Please join us: share your testimony, and add your voice.

With respect,

[Name, organisation]

IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION

Sometimes a moment is acute — a compact under negotiation, a dome assessment released, a claim before a body, a storm threatening the dome — and you cannot run the full effort. Triage to the levers that work fastest and strongest here, which means the documented injustice, the dome, and the world's conscience.

The First 48 Hours

Establish the essentials: **what harm and debt are documented, and what danger is present.** Identify the immediate moment — a **compact negotiation, a dome assessment, a claim, a storm** — because that is what you must affect first. Reach the **nation's institutions, the affected communities, and the international allies and media** at once, because for a wronged small nation the documented injustice and the world's conscience are the fastest routes to real leverage — and frame the moment around the double injustice, because that is what moves the world.

The Fastest-Moving Levers

Some levers work faster than others. **The dome accountability** can be made vivid at once — a leaking radioactive tomb the world can see. **The double injustice** can be framed immediately, joining the nuclear and climate causes. **The world's movements and media** can be engaged fast. **The compact leverage** can be pressed in the moment of negotiation. These outpace the slower work of legal cases and formal claims — which must follow — because the dome, the double injustice, and the world's conscience can be mobilised immediately. Above all, make the injustice and the danger visible to the world fast, because the world's attention is a small nation's swiftest strength.

Emergency Coalition-Building

You cannot build a full movement overnight, but here you can reach the world fast. Reach immediately to the **nation's institutions, the affected communities, the anti-nuclear and climate-justice movements, and the international media and allies.** A coalition making the injustice and the danger visible, and joining the world's conscience, is the most a rapid Marshallese effort can do — and the world's attention can move fast. Speed favours the prepared: know the record, the danger, and the double injustice before the moment breaks, and carry them to the world with dignity.

WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Here, honestly, the field is tilted by the sheer imbalance of power between a small nation and a great one, by the nation's dependence on the very ally it must hold to account, by that ally's insistence that the matter is settled, and by the fact that much of the harm cannot be undone and much of the climate threat lies beyond the nation's power. Name it plainly, because pretending the power is equal, or that the nation is not dependent, or that the harm can be undone, would be false.

Recognising a Tilted Field

The signs are specific and honest. **The power is unequal** — a small nation faces a great power. **The nation is dependent** — on the ally's assistance, migration, and defence. **The ally calls it settled** — resisting further responsibility. **And the harm is largely done** — the past cannot be undone, and the climate threat is global. This is a tilt of power, dependence, and history, and an effort here works it through the justice of the cause, the leverage of the compact, the visibility of the dome, the power of the double injustice, and the conscience of the world, not through force the nation lacks.

Strategies for a Tilted Field

When the field is tilted, use the levers of justice and the world's conscience. Lean on the **documented injustice**, which the record makes undeniable; the **compact leverage**, the relationship that is also dependence; the **dome accountability**, visible to all; the **double injustice**, which binds the world's movements; and the **world's law and conscience**, which can hold even the powerful to account before a watching world. Meet the ally's "settled" stance not with force but with the documented, undeniable truth that a leaking dome and an unpaid award are not settled. And build the record and the world's support over time, because the conscience of the world, once engaged, accumulates into pressure the powerful cannot forever ignore. A field tilted by power is worked through justice, dignity, and the world's conscience, which are a small nation's real strengths.

The Honest Possibility of Losing

You may not win the justice you seek — the ally may hold to "settled," the compensation may stay unpaid, the dome may go unaddressed, the seas may rise — and this guide will not pretend otherwise; the power is unequal and the struggle long. But here the work is never wasted: the **injustice was documented, the debt was named, the dome was made visible, the double wrong was carried to the world, and the powerful was held to account before the world's conscience** — and every recognition gained, every term won, every study forced, every conscience engaged advances the cause and honours the wronged. Press on with dignity; the justice struggle of the Marshallese has already made a small nation a moral leader of the world, and a cause the world will not let be called settled endures until it is answered.

WHEN IT'S NOT CORRUPTION BUT POWER — AND WHO ANSWERS

In the Marshall Islands, the honest reckoning is not primarily about corruption but about the imbalance of power between a small, wronged nation and the great power responsible: a documented injustice a mighty ally calls settled, a debt it will not pay, a dome it will not own. Yet there is also an honest domestic dimension — that the justice and the funds owed must actually reach the affected communities — and both are approached through transparency, the world's conscience, and the dignity of the wronged.

Telling Power from Corruption

In many struggles the concern is corruption; here it is chiefly the imbalance of power. The marks are specific: **a documented injustice the powerful call settled, an adjudicated debt left unpaid, a responsibility disowned, and a small nation's dependence used to blunt its claims**. Be clear and fair: **name the power imbalance as the core issue, and credit what has been done as well as what has not**, and rely on the documented record, the world's law, and the world's conscience, which can hold even the powerful to account. And attend honestly to the domestic dimension — that whatever justice and funds are won must reach the affected communities transparently, so that the wronged, not intermediaries, are made whole.

Responding to Power — Through Justice and the World, With Dignity

Where the imbalance of power denies justice, the response runs through the documented cause and the world's conscience. Use the **documented injustice and the adjudicated debt** to show the world that the matter is not settled. Use the **dome and the double injustice** to make the wrong visible and undeniable. Use the **world's law, bodies, and movements** to hold the powerful to account before a watching world.

And use the **compact leverage** to press the claim within the relationship. Attend to transparency at home, so that justice reaches the wronged. Document rigorously and carry the cause with dignity, because before the world, the dignified truth of a wronged people is a small nation's greatest power. Route the effort through justice, the world, and dignity — not through force the nation lacks.

A Note on Safety and Dignity

This note matters throughout. The Marshall Islands is a functioning democracy where people can speak, organise, and lead openly, so the safety concern here is not repression but the dignity, unity, and endurance of a long struggle against a powerful ally. So carry the cause with **dignity**, for the dignity of the wronged is the movement's strength; keep the affected communities' own voices at the center, for theirs is the moral authority; sustain unity and endurance, for the struggle is long; and handle the responsible state, the compact, the strategic relationship, and the complex history factually and evenhandedly, crediting what has been done as well as what has not, so the cause remains just and credible. Dignity here is not weakness; it is the recognition that a small nation's power against a great one lies in the undeniable, dignified truth of its cause and the conscience of the world, and that these are strongest when carried with unity, endurance, and grace.

INTEGRATION & TIMELINE: RUNNING ALL FIVE STEPS TOGETHER

The steps in this guide are written in sequence but run in parallel, each feeding the others — all through justice, the compact, and the world's conscience. Here is how they fit into a single, dignified Marshallese effort.

The Parallel Effort

From the start, the five run together. **Documentation** builds the injustice-and-danger record. **Target identification** aims it at the levers. **Local opposition**, understood as the community-and-world movement, organises the wronged, the nation, and the world. **Legal, regulatory, and nuclear-justice** work presses the accountability, the compact, and the cleanup. **Media**, on the world stage, carries the justice cause. The record feeds all five at once — a documented injustice is a legal claim, a compact argument, a dome demand, and a world story together. Run in parallel, they compound; run one at a time, they stall — and here, joining the atoll to the world, they compound into a justice cause the powerful must answer.

A Rough Timeline

Early (weeks 1–8): establish the injustice and the danger; identify the accountability, the compact leverage, the dome, and the double injustice; build the community-and-world movement and begin documentation.

Middle (months 2–24): press the accountability claim and the compact; demand the dome cleanup; frame the double injustice for the world; and engage the international bodies and movements. **Later (months and years):** pursue the justice, the compensation, the cleanup, and the recognition, and defend the nation against the rising seas, across a long and dignified struggle. A Marshallese effort is a long justice struggle, and its fruits — recognition, terms won, studies forced, the world engaged — come across years; pace it accordingly, and let dignity and endurance govern every step.

The Core Discipline

Through it all, hold the discipline that gives these efforts their force: **document the injustice and the debt; press the accountability and the dome cleanup; use the compact's leverage; frame the double**

injustice; engage the world's movements; and pursue justice with dignity. The movement that presses all five, joining the wronged communities to the nation and the world, and never letting the matter be called settled, is the one that can genuinely advance justice — the kind of moral victory a small nation, wronged twice and standing with dignity before the world, can win.

FINAL ASSESSMENT

Pursuing justice for the Marshall Islands is genuinely difficult, and bound up with the imbalance of power between a small nation and a great one, with the nation's dependence on the very ally it must hold to account, with that ally's insistence that the matter is settled, and with harm that cannot be undone and a climate threat beyond the nation's power, and this guide has been honest about that from its first line: the responsible party is a powerful ally the nation depends on, it treats the matter as settled, much harm is done, and justice is unfinished. And yet the effort is far from futile, because the injustice is documented and owed a debt, because the compact that binds the nation to the ally is also its leverage, because the leaking dome is a concrete accountability the world can see, because the meeting of the nuclear and climate wrongs is uniquely powerful, and because international law and the world's movements stand with the wronged — and those levers of justice, the compact, the dome, the double injustice, and the world's support are real.

Some honest truths hold across every effort here. **The injustice is documented and the debt adjudicated — the matter is not settled. The dome is a leaking, visible accountability the world can see. The nuclear-and-climate double injustice is a cause for the world's conscience. But the ally is powerful, the nation dependent, and the struggle long.** Hold both truths at once: real, distinctive levers of justice, accountability, and the world's conscience, and the honest weight of an unequal power and an unfinished struggle.

Above all, keep the discipline — and the dignity — that give these efforts their force. Document the injustice and the debt. Press the accountability and the dome cleanup. Use the compact's leverage. Frame the double injustice. Engage the world's movements. And pursue justice with dignity — because for a small nation wronged twice by the powers of the age, an effort that turns its injustice into a documented claim, carried with dignity before the world's conscience, is the one that is both effective and just.

The Marshall Islands is a nation of low atolls scattered across a vast ocean, whose people gave up their homelands to sixty-seven nuclear bombs, were left a leaking dome of radioactive waste, were promised a compensation still unpaid, and now watch the rising seas — driven by distant emissions — threaten to breach that very dome and their nation itself. This guide has hidden none of that, nor pretended that the responsible power will readily yield, or that the nation is not dependent upon it, or that the harm of the past can be undone, and there is no easy victory to promise you. But the Marshallese hold something that the powerful, for all their strength, cannot take: a cause so plainly just, so thoroughly documented, and so uniquely powerful — the wrong of the atom and the wrong of the carbon meeting in one small nation — that the world's conscience is theirs to summon, and the matter cannot honourably be called settled while a tribunal's award goes unpaid and a radioactive tomb leaks beneath a rising sea. There is no undoing the past, and no easy justice against a great power; this guide has said so throughout, and insisted on dignity for those who carry the cause. But the homelands and health and future of the Marshallese are worth every effort, the levers that run through justice, the compact, the dome, the double injustice, and the world's conscience are real, and the dignified, persistent work of documenting the injustice, demanding the accountability, and carrying the cause to the world is one the Marshallese have already made their own — and, standing small but unbowed before the great powers of the age, pursue justice for a people wronged twice. So can you.